

Request for Proposal (RFP)

For

Information Management Technology Platform

Request for Proposal No.: RFP-0575

Issued Date: May 15, 2023

Submission Deadline Date: **June 12, 2023, 2:00 p.m. local Saskatchewan time**

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PART 1 - INVITATION AND SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

1.1 Invitation to Proponents

This Request for Proposal (RFP) is an invitation by the Government of Saskatchewan (GOS) to prospective Proponents to submit proposals for the provision of Information Management Technology Platform in support of the Government of Saskatchewan's existing enterprise data analytics platform and proposed data management operating model, as further described in the **RFP Particulars (Appendix A)**.

The Government of Saskatchewan, Ministry of SaskBuilds and Procurement (SBP), is seeking competitive proposals for the procurement of support and related services for its technology platform to host reports and dashboards and integrate and warehouse data for the GOS. This includes planning, designing and implementing additional capabilities to augment existing enterprise services that Information Technology Division (ITD) provides.

SBP is the Government of Saskatchewan provincial ministry responsible for supplying services to ministries, agencies, boards and commissions that support efforts to build the economy and make a better life for all Saskatchewan people. The ITD within SBP facilitates the provisioning of secure business applications and technologies through vendor partners in support of the delivery of government services in the public interest.

ITD seeks to support the government organizations it serves, and the goal is to enhance the quality of decision-making for government programs and the delivery of services to citizens through continuous improvements to data management and analytics.

The current GOS contract for technical services for providing and maintaining an operational reporting and analytics environment is expiring. Further, a number of additional technical platform capabilities are needed to address functional requirements identified by the organizations ITD serves. Current advances in data management and analytics technologies must be accounted for and planned for, with an implementation plan based on ministries' priorities.

The required services (described in further detail in **Appendix A RFP Particulars Section B The Deliverables**) include:

- Managing and maintaining current investments delivered on a multi-tenant on-premises infrastructure, including:
 - Data Warehouse and Data Stores Design and Implementation Services;
 - Bulk Data Integration Services;
 - Managed Reporting and Analytics Support Services; and
 - Data Science Workspace Provisioning Services.
 - Data Management and Analytics software support, upgrades and maintenance
- Further consulting, provisioning, and deployment of solutions based on GOS the enterprise-class analytics platforms; and
- Technology platforms planning, design and orchestration of additional functionality supporting the evolution of the data management and analytics environment at GOS.

The desired outcome is a managed services agreement that ensures the orchestration of a seamless end-to-end service to government organizations through multiple platforms to a single point of oversight. This will be executed by a new kind of governance and orchestration model that encompasses an alliance mindset; industry-leading people, technology, tools and processes; a flexible contractual construct; and an innovative approach to transformation and change.

Key outcomes will be the availability, reliability, and performance of GOS data management and analytics solutions and workloads while optimizing the cost and value associated with managing existing and future workloads. This includes continuous improvement in data management practices to maintain high data protection standards, privacy compliance and responsible use through further investments in data governance.

This service will be procured directly with SBP, but the workloads will consist of data management and analytics requirements for many ministries, agencies, boards and commissions across GOS.

The purpose of the RFP is to identify those Suppliers capable of meeting the requirements in a feasible, economical and timely manner and with whom a contract can be negotiated. GOS' desire is to engage in a transformational contract and service arrangement for the future, one that will sustain existing data management and analytics platforms investments and ensure the benefits of new and progressive technologies and service offerings are implemented and deployed in a responsible and productive way, ultimately optimizing services and cost for the citizens of the province. This needs to be accomplished through a progressive, innovative, and future-oriented approach to the services that will require a vision of how Information Management Technology Platform services will and need to transform into the future.

SBP will consider entering into an agreement with one or more Service Providers, including Service Provider consortiums, to meet the product and services requirements specified in this RFP. SBP will consider consortiums proposed by the Proponent or, based on the value determined through the evaluation of responses, select Service Providers that would act as a consortium.

In multi-Service Provider submissions, the response should identify which Service Provider is the lead respondent and clearly articulate the details of any partnerships involved in service delivery, if applicable.

At this time, SBP will not commit to awarding all Service Requirements or portions of services within the Service Requirements outlined in this Competition. Instead, SBP may award portions of a Service Provider's proposed approach dependent on the value determined by GOS during the evaluation stages of this Competition.

Important Notice to Proponents:

- **This RFP will be associated with Request for Supplier Qualifications RFSQ # Information Management Technology Platform Consulting Services. The details of how this RFP relates to the associated RFSQ are further described in Appendix A – RFP Particulars, Section A – Background.**
- **Proponents responding to this RFP may also respond to the RFSQ.**

This Competition, as well as any resulting agreement(s), may be utilized (but does not include any proprietary ownership of source code) for the broader public sector within the province of Saskatchewan. This includes but is not limited to, non-government organizations (NGOs), crown corporations, government agencies, the MASH sector (MASH means regional, local, district or other forms of municipal government, school boards, publicly-funded academic, health and social service entities, as well as any entity owned or controlled by any one of the preceding), health districts, school boards, Indigenous governing bodies and organizations, First Nation organizations, Métis organizations and municipal governments (cities and/or towns) (hereinafter the "Broader Public Sector Agency" or "BPSA").

GOS shall not be liable in any manner whatsoever to any Broader Public Sector Agency for its use of this Competition process or any of its associated agreements, and GOS shall not be liable to the Proponent for any Broader Public Sector Agency's use of this Competition process or any associated agreements.

1.2 RFP Contact

For the purposes of this procurement process, the "RFP Contact" will be:

BTSpurchase@gov.sk.ca

Attention: Sheryl Plysiuk-Kolish RFP-0575

Proponents and their representatives are not permitted to contact any employees, officers, agents, elected or appointed officials or other representatives of GOS other than the RFP Contact concerning matters regarding this RFP. Failure to adhere to this rule may result in the disqualification of the Proponent and the rejection of the Proponent's proposal.

Inquiries and their responses may be posted on the website sasktenders.ca at the sole discretion of the GOS without revealing the source of the inquiry.

1.3 Type of Agreement for Deliverables

The selected Proponent(s) will be requested to enter into direct contract negotiations to finalize an Agreement with GOS for the provision of the Deliverables. GOS expects the terms and conditions set out in the Form of Agreement in Appendix C to be included in the final negotiated Agreement with the selected Proponent(s). Proponents choosing to participate in this RFP process should be prepared to accept those terms and conditions, subject only to changes that may be mutually agreed upon in the negotiation process.

It is GOS's intention to enter into an Agreement with **one (1) Proponent** to manage, orchestrate, and provide the delivery of these services.

The term of the Agreement is to be for a period of five **(5) years** with an option in favour of GOS to extend the Agreement for three (3) additional two (2) year terms on the same terms and conditions at GOS's discretion.

The Agreements(s) resulting from this RFP may include system software licensing, installation/configuration, data migration/implementation, identifiable project deliverables based on customer's needs, and yearly system infrastructure support and maintenance for the life of the solution.

GOS has the right to negotiate a holdback clause with the Preferred Service Provider that will be negotiated onto the Agreement.

Proponents are asked to review Appendix C – Form of Agreement and respond to Mandatory 1 in Appendix D – Mandatory Requirements. Suppliers that hold an active Ministry of SaskBuilds and Procurement's (formerly Central Services) Master Terms and Conditions are not required to review this Appendix.

1.4 RFP Timetable

Issue Date of RFP	May 15, 2023
Registration Deadline for Individual Proponent Conferences	May 19, 2023

Individual Proponent Conferences	May 25-29, 2023
Deadline for Questions	May 30, 2023
Deadline for Issuing Addenda	June 1, 2023
Submission Deadline for Stage II Written Evaluation 1	June 12, 2023, 2:00 p.m. local Saskatchewan time
Rectification Period	3 days after notification
Anticipated Initial Ranking	Week of June 26, 2023
Shortlisted Proponents to Stage III – Due Diligence	Week of July 3, 2023
Stage III – Due Diligence	July 10 – August 11, 2023
Submission Deadline for Stage IV – Written Evaluation 2 and Stage V – Pricing	August 14, 2023
Anticipated Ranking for Stage IV – Written Evaluation 2	Week of September 4, 2023
Proponents’ Presentation and/or Interview	September 11 – 22, 2023
Reference Checks (Optional)	As required
Anticipated Deadline for Submission of Best and Final Offers (“BAFO”) (Optional)	As required
Anticipated Final Ranking	TBD
Anticipated Execution of Agreement	TBD

The RFP timetable is tentative only and may be changed by GOS at any time.

1.4.1 Individual Proponent Conferences

Individual Proponents Conference may be scheduled as follows:

Date: Between May 25 and May 29, 2023
 Time: Between 8:30 a.m. and 4:30 p.m., Local Saskatchewan Time
 Duration: Up to 55 minutes
 Location: Teams Meeting, or as otherwise directed by GOS

Individual Proponent Conferences are an opportunity to meet with Ministry staff in private, one-on-one sessions to learn more about the scope of this Competition. The Individual Proponent Conferences are optional; proponents not requesting an Individual Proponent Conference may still submit a proposal. The conferences can be via phone or virtual meetings; they do not need to be attended in person.

GOS will not reimburse any expense associated with participating in Individual Proposed Conferences.

If you are interested in an Individual Proponents Conference, your request should be directed, in writing, before the date mentioned on the Timeline to:

Contact: BTSProcurement@gov.sk.ca
 Subject: Conference: RFP-0575

Your e-mail request should include the following:

1. Names and e-mail addresses of attendees from your organization.
2. A list of questions or agenda items you intend to table at the conference.

To ensure the quality of information, meeting minutes will be taken. Any questions and answers that clarify or change the requirements or that are process-related will be shared with all Proponents.

A Questions and Answers amendment posted to SaskTenders, without revealing the source of the inquiry, will be published listing topics discussed.

Steps may be taken to protect any proprietary information, if requested, in preparation of these materials. Verbal responses to any inquiry are not binding on either party.

1.5 Submissions of Proposals

1.5.1 Submissions

Submissions Proponents must submit by email only. GOS does not assume any responsibility for delayed or rejected Submissions. Proponents acknowledge that all risks associated with Submissions are their sole responsibility and that late Submissions, regardless of the reason, will be rejected.

Submitting by email:

One (1) electronic copy in .pdf, .doc or .docx, excel format, which includes the RFP reference number and closing date, is to be forwarded to:

response@gov.sk.ca

The subject line of the email should contain the RFP reference number and competition title.

One (1) email, including attachments, should not be larger than 25MB, or it may not be successfully transmitted. It is recommended to send one (1) email; however, if sending multiple emails, provide clear instructions on how the Submission is intended to be integrated.

Executable file formats such as .exe will not be accepted. The preferred file formats are .pdf, .doc, .docx, .xls and .xlsx.

The received time in the recipient's email inbox will be the recorded date and time of Submission. GOS will provide confirmation of email receipt to Proponents via an automatic email message. If no confirmation email is received, please contact 306-787-6871.

Prior to closing, GOS will maintain the confidentiality of e-mail Submissions subject to GOS officials opening an e-mail for the purpose of identification. In the event that one (1) or more files cannot be opened (e.g. are corrupted), the Proponent will not have an opportunity to resend such files after closing.

For more information, refer to the document Guidelines for Proponent Submissions via Email on [SaskTenders](#).

1.5.2 Proposals to be Received on Time

Proposals must be received at the location set out above on or before the Submission Deadline. Submissions received after the Submission Deadline will not be accepted.

Onus and responsibility rests solely with the Proponent to deliver its proposal to the exact location (including floor, if applicable) indicated in this RFP on or before the Submission Deadline. GOS does not accept any responsibility for proposals delivered to any other location by the Proponent or its delivery

agents. Proponents are advised to make Submissions well before the deadline. Proponents making Submissions near the deadline do so at their own risk.

1.5.3 *Intentionally Blank*

1.5.4 Amendment of Proposals

Proponents may amend their proposals prior to the Submission Deadline by submitting the amendment to the location set out above. Any amendment should clearly indicate the full legal name and return address of the Proponent, RFP title and number, and which part of the Submission the amendment is intended to amend or replace.

1.5.5 Withdrawal of Proposals

At any time prior to the execution of a written Agreement for the provision of the Deliverables, a Proponent may withdraw a submitted proposal. To withdraw a proposal, a notice of withdrawal must be received by the RFP Contact and signed by an authorized representative of the Proponent. GOS is under no obligation to return withdrawn proposals.

[End of Part 1]

PART 2 – EVALUATION AND NEGOTIATION

2.1 Stages of Evaluation and Negotiation

GOS will evaluate proposals and negotiations in the following stages:

2.2 Stage I – Requirements

GOS will review proposal components for administrative deficiencies and compliance with mandatory requirements.

Administrative Deficiencies

If GOS determines that a proposal fails to meet any of the mandatory submission requirements, GOS may, at its discretion, offer a rectification process. If a proposal fails to satisfy any of the mandatory or submission requirements, GOS may issue the Proponent a rectification notice identifying the deficiencies and providing the Proponent with an opportunity to rectify the deficiencies. If the Proponent fails to respond or to satisfy those mandatory or submission requirements within the Rectification Period, the proposal will be assessed on the initial proposal or eliminated from the process at GOS's direction. The Rectification Period will begin to run from the date and time that GOS issues a rectification notice to the Proponent. The mandatory and submission requirements are set out in Appendix D and Appendix A, Section F, respectively.

GOS may eliminate mandatory requirements unmet by all Proponents.

2.3 Stage II – Written Evaluation 1

GOS will evaluate each qualified proposal based on the following rated criteria as set out in **Appendix A Section D Rated Criteria**:

- D.1 Proponent Profile;
- D.2 Proponent Experience and Qualifications;
- D.3 Proposed Approach;
- D.4 Risk Management Plan;
- D.5 Proposed Team and Resources;
- D.6 Value Add-ons and Innovation; and
- D.7 Local / Industry Knowledge.

Based on the evaluated responses to these sections, shortlisted vendors will be invited to participate in the remaining stages of the evaluation (subsequent stages articulated below).

The terms “requirement,” “shall,” and “must” (or similar term used in this RFP) are used for convenience only and is not intended to imply that any proposal that does not exactly match or meet such a “requirement” will necessarily be disqualified. Instead, as part of the evaluation process, Proponents, goods and services will be evaluated based on the extent to which, and how well, they are able to satisfy the intent, fit for purpose and substance of the “requirements” or “specifications” contained in this RFP.

2.4 Stage III –Due Diligence

Proponents shortlisted from the previous stage will move on to the due diligence stage and will be required to sign an NDA substantially in the form attached as Appendix M – Confidentiality Agreement.

The intention of the due diligence stage is to allow for Proponent validation and discovery of further details of the existing enterprise data analytics environment for the purposes of:

- Confirming current state capabilities;
- Confirming the scope of the services and associated service level requirements;
- Informing a service transition plan;
- Confirming the Proponent's ability to comply with GOS security policies and standards in the delivery of services; and
- Pricing of the overall proposal.

This stage will consist of the Proponent being granted access to information pertaining to GOS's data management and analytics environment for the discovery and validation of the current and envisioned target environment.

GOS is expecting a planning session with each Proponent that is selected to proceed to Due Diligence as the first step of the process. The objectives of the planning session are to have the Proponent outline and confirm the information they require to complete **Sections D.8 to D.10 outlined in Appendix A, Section D Rated Criteria** as part of Stage IV Written Evaluation 2 and the Pricing of the proposal for Stage V. In this planning session, Proponents should be prepared to discuss the specific information they will need to complete their overall proposals.

GOS envisions, at a minimum, the required information will include the following:

1. The volume and detail of activities (number of repositories supported, and bulk integration jobs) associated with the existing services.
2. Detailed services and associated service level requirements for existing and future technology platform needs.
3. Current state technology capabilities to allow for a gap assessment (based on the Proponents understanding of modern data management technologies). This will allow for future planning and prioritization of target state architectures.
4. The relationship and provisioning of technical infrastructures provided by GOS's third-party vendors.

GOS envisions that Due Diligence will:

1. Occur over a three-week period. This includes up to but is not limited to, three meetings.
2. Require meetings with specific ITD groups, including the existing data management and analytics service teams, the strategy and architecture branch, and the security team.

Proponents will need to be prepared to identify and discuss the specific information they require, the GOS groups they wish to meet with, and time expectations of these groups.

Material and information obtained during due diligence remains the property of GOS. The information collected through this phase must remain within GOS due to the sensitive nature of the information. Please refer to Appendix M – Confidentiality Agreement.

2. Stage IV – Written Evaluation 2

GOS will evaluate each qualified proposal based on the rated criteria as set out in **Appendix A Section D Rated Criteria**:

- D.8 Service Delivery and Transition Plan;
- D.9 IT Requirements and Specifications; and
- D.10 Information Security Requirements.

The terms “requirement”, “shall”, “must” (or similar terms used in this RFP) is used for convenience only and is not intended to imply that any proposal that does not exactly match or meet such a “requirement” will necessarily be disqualified. Instead, as part of the evaluation process, Proponents, goods and services will be evaluated based on the extent to which, and how well, they are able to satisfy the intent, fit for purpose and substance of the “requirements” or “specifications” contained in this RFP.

Proponents will also have the opportunity to re-submit sections from the previous submission in Stage II, Written Evaluation 1. Any resubmission must clearly outline what has changed and provide justification as it relates to their findings in Stage III Due Diligence.

2.5 Stage V – Pricing

Proponents will be asked to submit pricing based on their findings in Stage III Due Diligence. Pricing must incorporate all service requirements to meet the Deliverables set out in Appendix A. GOS may choose to also provide scenarios for Proponents to provide pricing on as part of the evaluation.

The GOS reserves the sole right to reject any financial proposal that GOS deems to be materially deficient through omission or unreasonable estimates of time or cost that is necessary to provide the Services and Solution outlined in Appendix A, including any and all maintenance and support required.

2.5.1 Pricing

The scoring of the submitted pricing will be in accordance with the price evaluation set out in Appendix A.

Pricing will be kept separate from the written proposal evaluation. It will only be accessed after written proposals are completed.

2.6 Stage VI – Interviews/Presentations and Reference Checks

Top-ranked Proponent(s) may be invited to participate in the interview/presentation and reference check stage.

2.6.1 Interview/Presentation (Optional)

Top-ranked Proponent(s) may be required to attend an interview or make a presentation to the Evaluation Team. The interview can include a presentation. Materials prepared by the top-ranked Proponent(s) for the interview/presentation shall be provided to the Evaluation Team prior to the interview/presentation.

The interview/presentation is intended to verify that the proposed approach meets all of the requirements and provides the Evaluation Team with some exposure to the designated service team.

The interview/presentation may also be used to clarify any portion of the written proposal if required.

The Evaluation Team will ask questions about the contents of the proposal or presentation for clarification purposes. Clarifications made by the Proponent during the interview/presentation will become part of the Proponent's proposal and may be included in any contract negotiations.

2.6.2 Reference Checks (Optional)

Reference checks may be completed for the Proponent and/or their proposed resources and sub-contractors.

During reference checks, GOS reserves the right to contact any of the Proponent's customers who GOS believes may be able to provide information about the Proponent that would be pertinent to this RFP.

The GOS reserves the right to conduct reference checks at any time during the RFP process.

Proponents who receive unfavourable references, in the opinion of the GOS, may have their proposal rejected.

2.5 Stage VII – Best and Final Offer (BAFO) (Optional)

2.5.1 Initial Ranking of Proponents

After the completion of Stage VI, all scores from previous stages will be added together, and the Proponents will be ranked based on their total scores.

2.5.2 BAFO Process

GOS may invite the top-ranked Proponent(s) to enter BAFO. During BAFO, GOS may provide each of these Proponents with any additional information and seek further information and Submission improvements from each Proponent. After the expiration of the BAFO period, each Proponent may be invited to revise its initial Submission and submit its BAFO to GOS.

This process is typically used to address the following: confirming assumptions under which their Submission was developed; conducting whatever due diligence is deemed reasonable and necessary under the circumstances; proposing revisions to their Submission based upon the results of any activities discussed previously; and, provide more specific details in areas to be identified by GOS.

2.5.3 Evaluation of BAFO and Final Ranking of Proponents

Each BAFO will be re-evaluated and may be re-scored according to the evaluation criteria that will be provided in the BAFO process. A final ranking and decision may be made based on the new or additional information secured during this process. The top-ranked Proponent, based on the evaluation of each BAFO, will receive a written invitation to enter into a final round of negotiation to finalize the Agreement with GOS.

2.6 Stage VIII – Contract Negotiations

2.6.1 Contract Negotiation Process

Any negotiations will be subject to the process rules contained in the Terms and Conditions of the RFP Process (Part 3) and will not constitute a legally binding offer to enter into an Agreement on the part of GOS or the Proponent, and there will be no legally binding relationship created with any Proponent prior to the execution of a written Agreement. The terms and conditions in the Form of Agreement in Appendix C are intended to be included in the final negotiated Agreement with the selected Proponent. Negotiations may include requests by GOS for supplementary information from the Proponent to verify, clarify or supplement the information provided in its proposal or to confirm the conclusions reached in the evaluation and may include requests by GOS for improved pricing or performance terms from the Proponent.

2.6.2 Time Period for Negotiations

GOS intends to conclude negotiations and finalize the Agreement with the top-ranked Proponent. A Proponent invited to enter into direct negotiations should, therefore, be prepared to provide requested information in a timely fashion and to conduct its negotiations expeditiously.

2.6.3 Failure to Enter into an Agreement

GOS may, **at any time** at its sole discretion, discontinue negotiations with the top-ranked Proponent and may invite the next-best-ranked Proponent to enter into negotiations. This process will continue until an Agreement is finalized, until there are no more Proponents remaining that are eligible for negotiations or until GOS elects to cancel the RFP process.

2.6.4 Notification to Other Proponents

Other Proponents that may become eligible for contract negotiations will be so notified at the commencement of the negotiation process with the top-ranked Proponent. Once an agreement is finalized and executed by Purchasing Entity and a Proponent, the other Proponents will be notified in accordance with the Terms and Conditions of the RFP Process (Part 3).

[End of Part 2]

PART 3 - TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE RFP PROCESS

3.1 General Information and Instructions

3.1.1 Proponents to Follow Instructions

Proponents should structure their proposals in accordance with the instructions in this RFP. Where information is requested in this RFP, any response made in a proposal should reference the applicable section numbers of this RFP.

3.1.2 Proposals in English

All proposals are to be in English only.

3.1.3 No Incorporation by Reference

The entire content of the Proponent's proposal should be submitted in a fixed form, and the content of websites or other external documents referred to in the Proponent's proposal but not attached may not be considered to form part of its proposal. If Proponents wish to reference websites or external documents, they should obtain the approval of the RFP Contact prior to the Submission Date. Proponents are responsible for ensuring that all external content that is referenced is accurate and are to provide notice to GOS of any changes that may arise after Submission. GOS may, at any time, require a Proponent to provide a hard copy of some or all of the external content referenced.

3.1.4 References and Past Performance

In the evaluation process, GOS may consider information provided by the Proponent's references and may also consider information independently obtained by GOS about the Proponent or its proposal in the course of GOS's own due diligence, including any previous dealings or experience, if any, with a Proponent. GOS may contact any of the Proponent's customers who GOS believes may be able to provide information about the Proponent that would be pertinent to this RFP.

Proponents who have unfavourable past performance, in the opinion of the GOS, may have their proposal rejected.

The contractual performance of GOS's vendors is a matter of paramount importance to the ministry and Crown organizations. Each organization may monitor and assess a vendor's contractual performance and reserves the right to take past contractual performance into account when evaluating future bids from the vendor.

3.1.5 Information in RFP Only an Estimate

GOS and its advisers make no representation, warranty or guarantee as to the accuracy of the information contained in this RFP or issued by way of addenda. Any quantities shown or data contained in this RFP or provided by way of addenda are estimates only and are for the sole purpose of indicating to Proponents the general scale and scope of the Deliverables. It is the Proponent's responsibility to obtain all the information necessary to prepare a proposal in response to this RFP.

3.1.6 Proponents to Bear Their Own Costs

The Proponent will bear all costs associated with or incurred in the preparation and presentation of its proposal, including, if applicable, costs incurred for interviews or demonstrations.

3.1.7 Proposal to be Retained by GOS

GOS will not return the proposal or any accompanying documentation submitted by a Proponent.

3.1.8 Trade Agreements

Proponents should note that procurements falling within the scope of one or more of the following:

- The New West Partnership Trade Agreement;
- The World Trade Organization Agreement on Government Procurement;
- Chapter 19 of the Canada – European Union Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement, including its incorporation by reference into the Agreement on Trade Continuity between the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland and Canada;
- Chapter 15 of the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership; or
- Chapter 5 of the Canadian Free Trade Agreement.

Are subject to those trade agreements, but the rights and obligations of the parties will be governed by the specific terms of this RFP.

3.1.9 No Guarantee of Volume of Work or Exclusivity of Agreement

GOS makes no guarantee of the value or volume of work to be assigned to the successful Proponent. The Agreement to be negotiated with the selected Proponent will not be an exclusive contract for the provision of the described Deliverables. GOS may contract with others for goods and services the same as or similar to the Deliverables or may obtain such goods and services internally.

3.1.10 Evaluation Committee

Evaluation of Submissions will be by a committee formed by the GOS, which may include employees, consultants and contractors of the GOS.

3.2 Communication after Issuance of RFP

3.2.1 Proponents to Review RFP

Proponents should promptly examine all of the documents comprising this RFP and may direct questions in writing or seek additional information to the RFP Contact on or before the Deadline for Questions. No such communications are to be directed to anyone other than the RFP Contact. GOS is under no obligation to provide additional information, and GOS is not responsible for any information provided by or obtained from any source other than the RFP Contact. It is the responsibility of the Proponent to seek clarification from the RFP Contact on any matter it considers to be unclear. GOS is not responsible for any misunderstanding on the part of the Proponent concerning this RFP or its process.

3.2.2 All New Information to Proponents by Way of Addenda

This RFP may be amended only by an addendum in accordance with this section. If GOS, for any reason, determines that it is necessary to provide additional information relating to this RFP, such information will be communicated to all Proponents by addendum. Any information obtained in a method other than an addendum should not be relied upon. Each addendum forms an integral part of this RFP and may contain important information, including significant changes to this RFP. Proponents are responsible for obtaining all addenda issued by GOS.

3.2.3 Post-Deadline Addenda and Extension of Submission Deadline

If GOS determines that it is necessary to issue an addendum after the Deadline for Issuing Addenda, GOS may extend the Submission Deadline for a reasonable period of time.

3.2.4 Verify, Clarify and Supplement

When evaluating proposals, GOS may, at its sole discretion, request further information from the Proponent or third parties in order to verify, clarify or supplement the information provided in a proposal. The response received by GOS shall, if accepted by GOS, form an integral part of the Proponent's proposal.

GOS may consider information independently obtained by GOS about the Proponent or its Submission in the course of GOS's own due diligence, including any previous dealings or experience by it or others, if any, with a Proponent.

3.2.5 Time Disputes

In the event of a dispute regarding time, GOS's time clock will govern.

3.3 Notification and Debriefing

3.3.1 Notification to Other Proponents

Once an Agreement is signed by GOS and a Proponent, the other Proponents will be notified. Proponents may be notified by public posting in the same manner that this RFP was originally posted of the outcome of the procurement process.

3.3.2 Debriefing

Proponents who submit a proposal may request a debriefing after receipt of notification of the outcome of the procurement process. All requests must be in writing to the RFP Contact within thirty (30) days of such notification. The intent of the debriefing information session is to aid the Proponent in presenting a better proposal for subsequent procurement opportunities. Any debriefing provided is not for the purpose of providing an opportunity to challenge the procurement process or its outcome.

3.4 Conflict of Interest and Prohibited Conduct

3.4.1 Conflict of Interest

GOS may disqualify a Proponent or take any other action it deems appropriate in its sole discretion for any conduct, situation or circumstances determined by GOS, in its sole and absolute discretion, to constitute a Conflict of Interest.

For the purposes of this RFP, "Conflict of Interest" includes any situation or circumstance where, in relation to a GOS procurement competition, a participating Proponent has an unfair advantage, a perception of an unfair advantage or engages in conduct, directly or indirectly, that may give it an unfair advantage, including:

- (a) having, or having access to, information in the preparation of its proposal that is not available to other Proponents, but such does not include information a Proponent may have obtained in the past performance of a contract with a public entity, including GOS, that is not related to the creation, implementation or evaluation of this or a related procurement competition;

- (b) communicating with any person with a view to influencing preferred treatment in this procurement competition (including but not limited to the lobbying of decision makers involved in this procurement competition); or
- (c) engaging in conduct that compromises, or could be seen to compromise, the integrity of the open and competitive procurement competition or renders that competition non-competitive, less competitive, or unfair.

All Proponents should advise GOS in writing whether it has any actual, potential or perceived Conflict of Interest, and if so, the nature of each Conflict of Interest. A Proponent may, at the sole discretion of GOS, be disqualified from this RFP process if a Proponent is found to have a Conflict of Interest.

3.4.2 Disqualification for Prohibited Conduct

GOS may disqualify a Proponent, rescind an invitation to negotiate or terminate a contract subsequently entered into, or take such other action it may deem appropriate if GOS, in its sole and absolute discretion, determines that the Proponent has engaged in any conduct prohibited by this RFP.

3.4.3 Prohibited Proponent Communications

Proponents should not engage in any communications that could constitute a Conflict of Interest.

3.4.4 Proponent Not to Communicate with Media

Proponents should not at any time directly or indirectly communicate with the media in relation to this RFP or any Agreement entered into pursuant to this RFP without first obtaining the written permission of the RFP Contact.

3.4.5 No Lobbying

Proponents should not, in relation to this RFP or the evaluation and selection process, engage directly or indirectly in any form of political or other lobbying whatsoever to influence the selection of the successful Proponent(s).

3.4.6 Employee Submissions

GOS employees (as a Proponent or a proposed resources) may be ineligible to enter into an Agreement.

3.4.7 Illegal or Unethical Conduct

Proponents are not to engage in any illegal business practices, including activities such as bid-rigging, price-fixing, bribery, fraud, coercion or collusion. Proponents are not to engage in any unethical conduct, including lobbying, as described above, or other inappropriate communications; offering gifts to any employees, officers, agents, elected or appointed officials or other representatives of GOS; deceitfulness; submitting proposals containing misrepresentations or other misleading or inaccurate information; or any other conduct that compromises or may be seen to compromise the competitive process provided for in this RFP.

3.4.8 Past Performance or Past Conduct

GOS may prohibit a Proponent from participating in this or future procurement processes based on past performance or based on inappropriate conduct in a prior procurement process, including but not limited to the following:

- (a) illegal or unethical conduct as described above;

- (b) the refusal of the Proponent to honour its submitted pricing or other commitments; or
- (c) any conduct, situation or circumstance determined by GOS, in its sole and absolute discretion, to have constituted an undisclosed Conflict of Interest.

3.5 Confidential Information

3.5.1 Confidential Information of GOS

All information provided by or obtained from GOS in any form in connection with this RFP either before or after the issuance of this RFP

- (a) is the sole property of GOS and must be treated as confidential;
- (b) is not to be used for any purpose other than replying to this RFP and the performance of any subsequent Agreement for the Deliverables;
- (c) must not be disclosed without prior written authorization from GOS; and
- (d) must be returned by the Proponent to GOS immediately upon the request of GOS.

3.5.2 Confidential Information of Proponent

Proposals will be accepted in confidence, as they contain financial, commercial, scientific, technical and/or labour relations information, except as may be otherwise provided herein. The confidentiality of such information will be maintained by GOS, except as otherwise required by law or by order of a court or tribunal, or by regulatory order of the Government of Saskatchewan, including but not limited to the Crown Investment Corporation of Saskatchewan and other agencies or ministries of government including its boards, commissions or panels. Proponents are particularly advised that GOS is subject to legal requirements that may require disclosure of Submission information, including, without limitation, under *The Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act* (Saskatchewan). Notwithstanding the foregoing, GOS reporting requirements may result in the public disclosure of dollars paid to the successful vendor from any Agreement awarded.

Proponents are advised that their proposal will, as necessary, be disclosed, on a confidential basis, to advisers retained by GOS and/or to Crown corporations (as defined in The Crown Corporations Act, 1993) and GOS agencies or ministries, including its boards, commissions or panels, to advise or assist with the RFP process, including the evaluation of proposals. If a Proponent has any questions about the collection and use of personal information pursuant to this RFP, questions are to be submitted to the RFP Contact.

3.6 Procurement Process Non-binding

3.6.1 No Contract A and No Claims

This procurement process is not intended to create and will not create a formal, legally binding bidding process and will instead be governed by the law applicable to direct commercial negotiations. For greater certainty and without limitation:

- (a) this RFP will not give rise to any Contract A – based tendering law duties or any other legal obligations arising out of any process contract or collateral contract; and

- (b) neither the Proponent nor GOS will have the right to make any claims (in contract, tort, or otherwise) against the other with respect to the award of a contract, failure to award a contract or failure to honour a proposal submitted in response to this RFP.

3.6.2 No Contract Until Execution of Written Agreement

This RFP process is intended to identify prospective Proponents for the purposes of negotiating potential Agreements. No legal relationship or obligation regarding the procurement of any good or service will be created between a Proponent and GOS by this RFP process. A legal relationship will not arise until the successful negotiation and execution of a written Agreement.

3.6.3 Non-Binding Price Estimates

While the pricing information provided in proposals will be non-binding prior to the execution of a written Agreement, such information will be assessed during the evaluation of the proposals and the ranking of the Proponents. Any inaccurate, misleading or incomplete information, including withdrawn or altered pricing, could adversely impact any such evaluation or ranking or the decision of GOS to enter into an Agreement for the Deliverables.

3.6.4 Effect of this RFP

This RFP process does not in any way restrict or limit GOS's pre-existing rights to engage in commercial negotiations with any vendor or to procure the Deliverables from any vendor through any other process. Without limiting the generality of the foregoing, GOS may:

- (a) choose whether to evaluate any proposal;
- (b) modify this RFP or RFP process, including any technical, commercial or contractual terms;
- (c) re-issue this RFP, either in the same form or with modifications;
- (d) begin or end negotiations with any Proponent for some or all of the Deliverables;
- (e) reject any proposal;
- (f) abandon its plans to obtain any of the Deliverables;
- (g) invite anyone (including any Proponent) to give it an offer to provide some or all of the Deliverables under any terms;
- (h) at any time before awarding the Agreement, GOS may do the following:
 - require the Proponent to submit further information not requested in this RFP to verify the Proponent's ability to perform the Agreement, including financial data, references to support assertions of past relevant experience, information about the Deliverables, and proof of the Proponent's legal capacity to perform the Agreement;
 - inspect the Proponent's equipment and facilities that will be used to perform the Agreement to verify the Proponents' technical or commercial capacity to perform the Agreement; and
- (i) cancel the RFP process without liability at any time.

3.7 Governing Law and Interpretation

These Terms and Conditions of the RFP Process (Part 3):

- (a) are intended to be interpreted broadly and independently (with no particular provision intended to limit the scope of any other provision);

- (b) are non-exhaustive and must not be construed as intending to limit the pre-existing rights of the parties to engage in pre-contractual discussions in accordance with the common law governing direct commercial negotiations; and
- (c) are to be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the Province of Saskatchewan and the federal laws of Canada applicable therein.

[End of Part 3]

APPENDIX A - RFP PARTICULARS

A. BACKGROUND

The data management and analytics efforts within ITD have historically focused on establishing common technology services for the executive Ministries within the Government of Saskatchewan. This included the creation of the enterprise Operational Reporting Service (eORS) for establishing data repositories with basic query and reporting capabilities. Advanced analytics capabilities have also been pursued through cross-ministry collaboration. These investments have had various levels of adoption and success.

Continued research into industry practices as well as participation in public service organization discussions with peers across Canada, have highlighted the need to focus beyond the delivery of common technologies. The critical success factors in reaching data and analytics objectives require focus in four key areas:

- Leadership and collaborative governance
- Organizational culture
- Data management competencies and capacity
- Service delivery and technology infrastructure

The current GOS contract for service delivery and technology infrastructure for the operational reporting and analytics (eORS) environment is expiring. The approach for continuing these technical capabilities will include considerations for the broader set of critical capabilities highlighted above.

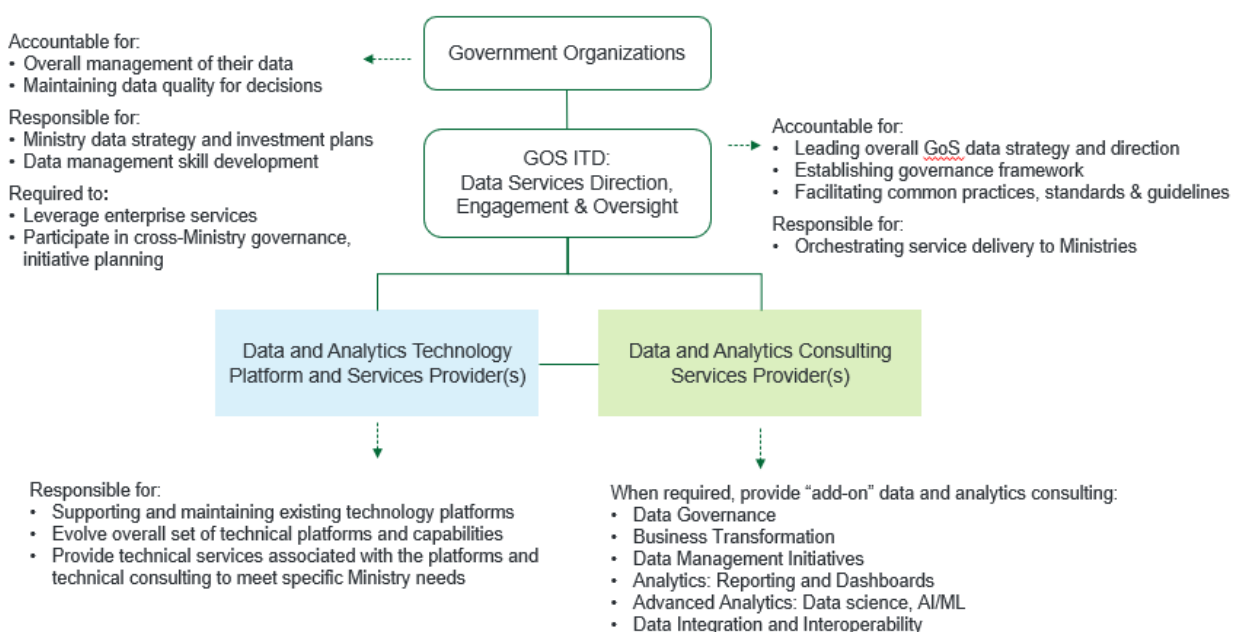
The ongoing reporting and analytics capabilities of these services need to keep pace with innovation in both technical capabilities as well as common processes. This includes:

- Continuous improvement in data management practices to maintain high data protection standards and responsible use through further investments in data governance.
- Realizing future value opportunities with an enhanced and broader set of functional capabilities, including data stewardship, quality management, data masking (anonymization), and advanced analysis.

Ultimately, these investments provide the ability to improve service delivery to the citizens in the province, the effectiveness of government programs, and the economic outcomes envisioned in *Saskatchewan's Growth Plan for the Next Decade of Growth 2020-2030*.

Envisioned Operating Model

In support of the outcomes and objectives for improved data management, as well as expanding access to IT Sector innovation and expertise, a new operating model has been envisioned within Saskatchewan. This includes relationships and interactions between the respective government organizations, GOS ITD, technology platform and data management and analytic consulting providers, as depicted in the diagram below:

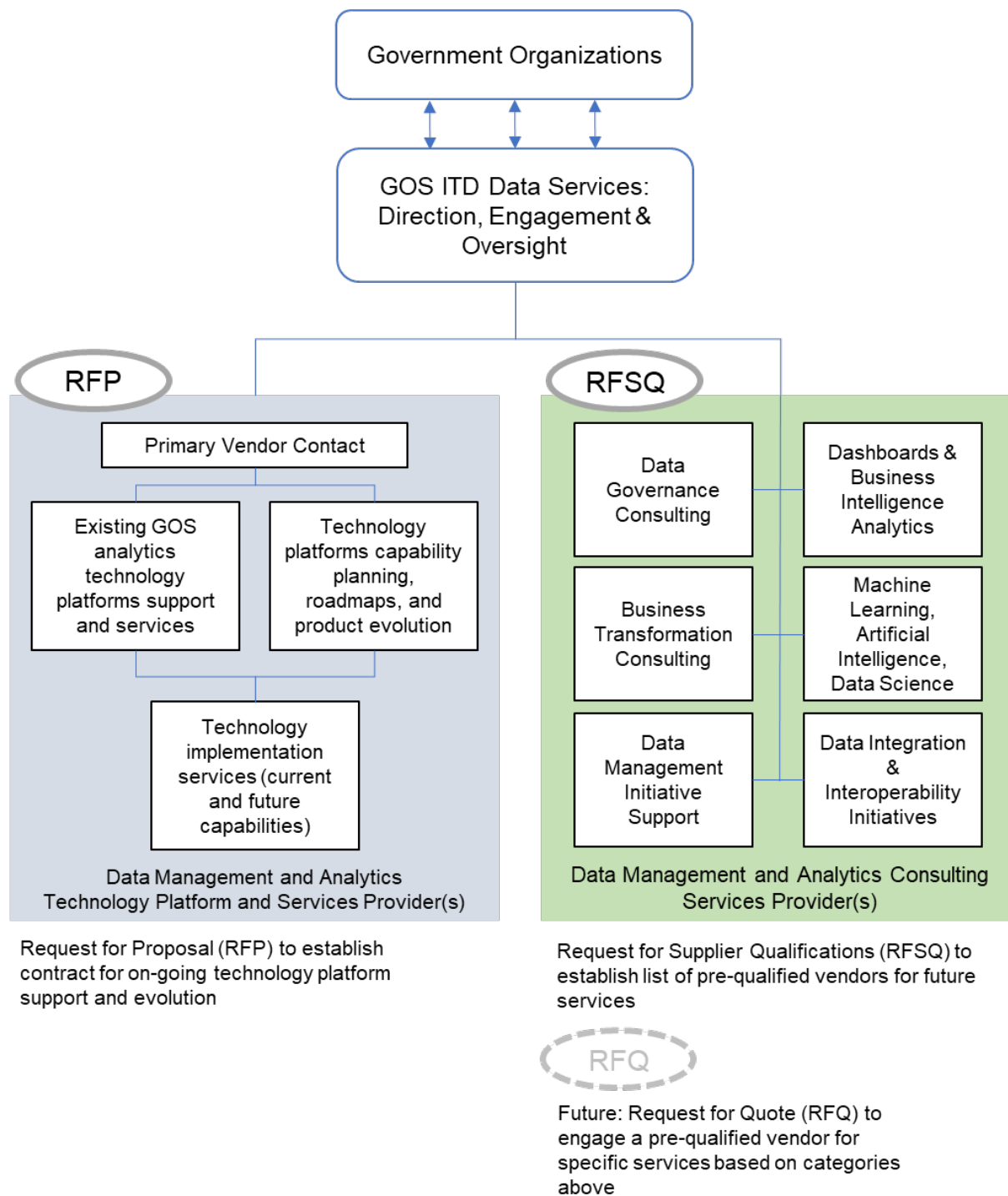


Approach for Procuring Information Management Technology Platform Services

Historically, the enterprise operational reporting services have been provided through a single vendor contract. Moving forward, the evolution and support for the technical platforms is envisioned to be through a *primary service provider* as outlined in this RFP. This vendor will be responsible to orchestrate partner organizations (if proposed) in delivering the overall technical platform services envisioned in this RFP.

In addition, considering Saskatchewan Growth plan objectives, access to a broader set of related data management consulting services in the IT sector is also desired. The intention is to provide Government organizations access to a broader set of qualified data management consulting providers to increase the overall availability of services and innovation within the IT Sector. Access to these future consulting services to complement and augment the envisioned operating model will be through an associated Request for Supplier Qualifications (RFSQ) to be posted in the near future.

The following diagram depicts the procurement approach to services:



Information Management Technology Platform Services

Through this RFP, GOS is looking for Proponents to assume holistic responsibility for the current platform support environment and provide transformational assistance to architect, design, implement and support target platform environments providing scale and additional capabilities. The current platform environments will need to be managed and evolved in parallel to any platform transformations.

In addition, GOS is looking to implement an enhanced governance and orchestration model whereby the successful Proponent will provide operations oversight for the in-scope assets and services and over other technology suppliers on behalf of GOS. The overall objective is for GOS to focus its attention and creativity on directly serving the evolving needs of the Government of Saskatchewan and its citizens and work with a partner that will manage all of the day-to-day activities of Information Technology, providing a single seamless service management process.

The deliverables outlined herein form the framework within which this partnership will function and the IT services to be delivered.

A.1 MATERIAL DISCLOSURES

A.1.1 Scope

It is the intention of ITD to continue to support the current technology platforms established and described in this RFP. This does not imply the evolution of data management and analytics products will be limited to these products. Nor does it imply GOS is looking to re-platform the existing services. Proponents are encouraged to provide target state visions based on modern approaches to data management and analytics, which they believe can complement and support the evolution of the technology platforms currently being used.

GOS envisions the services may evolve over time as the ministry undergoes growth and adapts to meet industry trends.

GOS expects the service provider to be able to adjust service offerings to meet the changing needs of the GOS. This involves reviewing emerging trends and issues, providing innovative strategies to proactively address shifting priorities, changing circumstances and unexpected events, and adjusting practice standards and delivery methods as required.

The scope of the services envisioned in this RFP is focused on the current investments for Information Management Technology Platform services. These services provide common capabilities for ministries, agencies, boards and commissions.

Direct support for imbedded or bundled reporting and analytics products for line of business applications *are not in scope* of the support services being requested in this RFP. This being said, Proponents are expected to have an understanding of modern approaches to accessing, integrating or consolidating the required data from line of business applications (including the Software as a service model) for reporting or analysis purposes.

GOS requires Proponents to understand the overall technical environments and enterprise services being offered within the Government for the ministries it serves. These services are outlined in Appendix H: Infrastructure Architecture, and the standards are outlined in Appendix F: ITD Environment.

A.1.2 Contract

The intended target date for transitioning existing services to the successful Proponent is January 1, 2024.

GOS intends that any contract resulting from this competition be in place prior to the current contract expiration. This competition and potential transition are ongoing while the current contract is active to avoid a gap in service provision which could be detrimental to GOS's ability to deliver services.

It is the intention of GOS to include flexibility for innovative approaches throughout the engagement as it relates to contract lifecycle. To meet the full objectives of this RFP, the requirement is for a single vendor to be responsible and accountable for the overall delivery of technology platform services. This does not imply a single vendor must provide all services. Partnerships or consortiums to deliver the services will be given equal consideration.

The current service provider will be permitted to respond to this RFP.

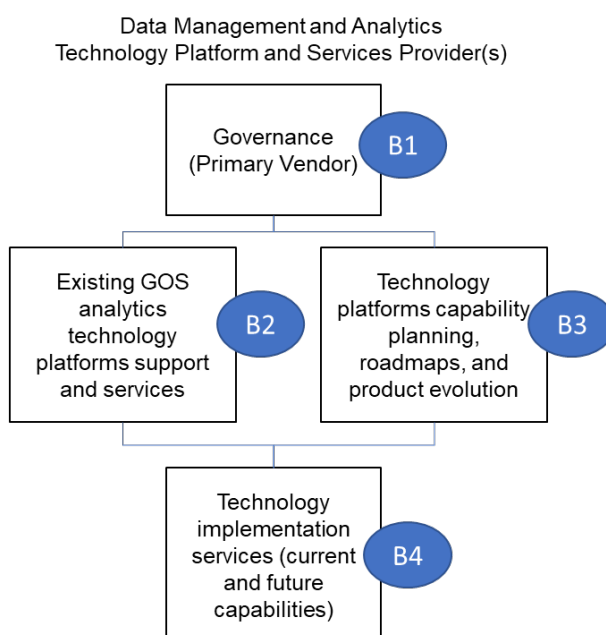
Budget for this initiative will be disclosed to Proponents that have been shortlisted to the Due Diligence phase.

The successful Proponent will also be permitted to respond to the corresponding RFSQ.

B. THE DELIVERABLES

The Deliverables of this RFP reflect the need to renew technical platform support and related implementation services based on existing Enterprise Information Management Technology Platform products and investments that host reports and dashboards, integrate and warehouse data for the GOS.

The required services also include the need to collaboratively establish a vision for ongoing transformation to emerging data management and analytics technologies, not restricted to current products, to be delivered through cloud or managed service models. Working with ITD, the Proponent will be responsible for facilitating the requirements, architecture, design, selection of product, and integration of additional capabilities. Key to this endeavor will be the ability of Proponents to partner with GOS to maintain services stability while engaging in change. The envisioned services have been grouped into four areas and are described in more detail in the sections (colored references) below:



B.1 Governance

The cornerstone of the envisaged managed services agreement is the governance model. Governance is defined as the sum of all processes, tools and touchpoints supporting the services defined in this RFP. Successful governance ensures the orchestration of multiple vendors and providers; and the effective execution of strategic engagement, relationship management, service demand management and service delivery. GOS envisions a seamless delivery of end-to-end service through a managed services provider acting as a single point of management for the Government of Saskatchewan's enterprise-based data management and analytics service workloads. The key elements of the governance model include the following deliverables and services, which are described in further detail below:

- Strategic Engagement;
- Orchestration and Vendor Management;
- Relationship Management; and
- Service Demand Management.

Strategic Engagement Strategic engagement is the process and framework within which GOS and the successful Proponent will build the partnership and envisioned operating model (**See Appendix A Section A Background**). The Proponent is expected to include, at a minimum:

- A Relationship Strategic Plan – a process and cadence that will engage GOS stakeholders in priorities planning and ensure the Proponent is aligned to their transformation objectives.
- A Value Realization Process – GOS envisions innovation and continuous improvement within the managed services agreement focused on business value realization.
- Service Transformation – a process to engage and support GOS in its transformation journey and lead a mosaic of service providers and partners in the delivery chain.

Orchestration and Vendor Management: The Proponent is expected to play a significant role in the overall orchestration of services. GOS envisions at a minimum the Proponent to collaboratively plan and establish:

- The vendor management process and approach for working with multiple internal and external parties towards common objectives. This includes the ability to manage and collaborate with multiple vendors on behalf of ITD.

Relationship Management: The Proponent is expected to provide a solid relationship management framework that includes but is not limited to:

- The Proponent's coverage model which includes the account team structure, roles and responsibilities, skills, and seniority levels proposed. It is critical that within these roles there is a designated senior architect with end-to-end understanding of the environments and solutions.
- ITD is looking for a Proponent that is capable of compiling and keeping up to date a Governance Procedures Manual that includes all processes referred to in this section B.1 integration with ITD Governance processes.

Service Demand Management: The Proponent is expected to play a significant role in demand management. This includes the processes required to monitor, forecast and respond to GOS service requests associated with data management and analytics. At a minimum, these include:

- Standard service requests – these are requests for services that are included in the scope of contracted services activated on an ad hoc basis or upon request.
- Non-standard service requests / Change order requests – these are requests for service that are out of scope and billable, subject to a rate card that will be negotiated as part of the managed services contract.
- Project requests – these are requests for larger initiatives that must be scoped, estimated, approved and executed within the context of a formal project.

B.2 Managed Services for Current Data Management and Analytics Platforms

One of the core objectives of this RFP is to secure services for the continued sustenance of the existing Information Management Technology Platforms utilized as Enterprise services to Government Ministries and organizations. This includes providing direct support services for the ITD Enterprise Operational Reporting Services (eORS) and supplemental support services for the Enterprise GIS and Business Intelligence environments. These are further described below.

Direct Support of the Enterprise Operational Reporting Services Environment (eORS)

The Enterprise Operational Reporting Service (eORS) is the technical platform and related services to host reports and integrate and warehouse data for the Government of Saskatchewan (GOS) based on the IBM Infosphere and IBM Cognos product sets.

Managed through ITD, this third-party service consists of the following:

- Design, implementation and support of central data warehouses or data stores;
- Bulk data integration – extract/transform/load (ETL) services;
- Support and consulting for ministries’ dashboards and reports;
- Consulting, design and implementation of required controls in support of GIS security requirements;
- Collaborative provisioning of on-demand workspaces for data science initiatives;
- Delivering support services to defined service levels based on the criticality of the repository and related reports;
- Planning, support and maintenance of the associated technical platforms (production and non-production)
- Coordination with the technical infrastructure provider (compute, storage and database support) to provide the analytics platform on a multi-tenant infrastructure; and
- Additional consulting and initiative support based on a rate card or project quoted basis.

Proponents are required to manage and support these services, including, but not limited to:

- Data Warehouse and Data Stores Support Services, at a minimum, this includes:
 - Architectural guidance, design (including logical DBA support) and on-boarding of new tenants;
 - Data security planning, access roles management; and
 - Service coordination and interaction with the infrastructure vendor.
- Bulk Data Integration Services for managing the Extract, Transform, Load (ETL) processes from source to target repositories (ranging from on-premises to Software as a Service application). At a minimum, these services include:
 - Support and guidance of the IBM Infosphere toolsets;
 - Architectural and data integration guidance, design, development, documentation and on-boarding of new tenants and ETL jobs;
 - Monitoring and providing break-fix support for scheduled integration processes; and
 - Overseeing the management and security controls of ETL processes, source code, and access to data sources.
- Managed Reporting and Analytic Services. At a minimum, these services include:
 - Support and guidance of the IBM Cognos toolsets, enabling reporting and analytics use within ministries, agencies, boards and commissions;
 - Design and recommendations for security;
 - Creation of client workspaces, data source connections and security;
 - Monitoring, alerting and break/fix of scheduled reporting jobs; and
 - “How to” support for clients.
- Data Science Workspace Provisioning Services. At a minimum, these services include:
 - Technical planning for the provisioning of “Data Science” workspaces;
 - Collaborative definition of software requirements and configuration of virtual desktops; and
 - Architecting and designing access models based on Ministry needs.
- Overall Service Management

- Service Level Management and Reporting;
- Service Portfolio Management – Relationship management, service catalog management, service performance and improvement, service design and transition, and 3rd party supplier management; and
- Software platform management
 - Version upgrades, release management and regular maintenance of the “in-score” platform components including, but not limited to IBM Infosphere and IBM Cognos;
 - Coordination of changes with the infrastructure provider; and
 - Tracking and managing license requirements.

Supplemental Support of Related Information Management Technology Platform Support Services

In addition to the direct support for the eORS environment as described above, ITD requires Proponent experienced resources with skillsets to augment ITD’s existing resources and service providers supporting ESRI’s ArcGIS Enterprise and Microsoft Power BI platforms.

Engagement will be on an “as required” basis and may include architectural planning and design of solutions, implementation of repositories, integration and data loads, query and analytics guidance, and on-going maintenance and support of the solutions.

B.3 Information Management Technology Platform Planning

The second core objective of this RFP is to further advance the Information Management Technology platform capabilities that are in alignment with Government Ministry and Organization needs, as well as keeping pace with advances in data and analytics technologies. The future IT and application footprint of GOS will be transformed over time from the more traditional hosting it is currently characterized by, to a hybrid that includes traditional and array of cloud hosting options emerging in the marketplace. This direction puts additional considerations for data management and analytics that must be effectively addressed.

GoS is looking for a Proponent with the capability to provide strategic, tactical and operational business planning, management and prioritization services as defined in the envisioned operating model. GOS requires the Proponent to partner and to assist GOS in defining transformation objectives, plans and strategies and partner in their execution. Transformation represents a significant opportunity map for the successful Proponent.

To this end, the Proponent is required to provide technology platform planning services to provide a Information Management Technology investment roadmap in support of a data management improvement program for the government. Working with ITD and the respective government ministries, agencies, boards and commissions to prioritize requirements, the roadmap must address:

- Existing technology gaps in data governance, data management, and data stewardship. For example, potential enterprise services could include common solutions for:
 - Data quality management (identifying, understanding and correcting flaws in data)
 - Data cataloging and inventory management, including metadata management (detailed information about the data within the repository)
 - Data masking (anonymizing private and confidential data to allow for development and testing of applications, and/or providing data for analysis and reporting while addressing confidentiality requirements)

- Improving access to enterprise-level, trustworthy data with clear business context to deliver government services including, but not limited to: assets, planning; operations; finance; service consumers; people; safety, and environment
- Providing secured self-serve access to data repositories with business context, centralized reporting, analytics and interactive dashboards
- Extending current reporting to leverage forecasting and predictive analytics

Key to this service is identifying both the business value and investment requirements that can support both the short- and long-term budgeting processes within GOS. The investment roadmap must be accompanied by periodic data and analytics technical architecture reviews and refinements, collaboratively with ITD.

B.4 Service Delivery Transformation and Additional Capability Implementation

The underlying objectives of this RFP are to ensure that GOS is getting best value for its investment in IT managed services and to establish a partnership with a managed services provider to assist in the transformation journey currently underway and yet to come.

GOS will use this RFP to build a “transformational” managed services agreement that emphasizes partnership and flexibility. The successful Proponent will be expected to work along with the ministries and agencies of the Government of Saskatchewan as well as the IT Sector to be partners in change. This will require an alliance mindset and a contractual construct that accommodates the evolution of services over the term. Governance and orchestration will also be the framework within which the contractual changes required will be managed and where transformation initiatives will be launched through the project & initiatives planning prioritization processes within GOS.

Working with ITD, the Proponent will be expected to facilitate the implementation of the data management and analytics roadmap (**described in B.3 Platform Planning above**) to introduce new technologies to expand analytic capabilities while establishing a sound extensible foundation.

The rollout of initiatives must add value to the business stakeholders by facilitating analytical insights that inform decisions, advance Ministry programs and service delivery to the citizens and businesses in the province. The technical rollout must be accompanied by effective knowledge transfer to provide GoS resources, both business and technical, with the knowledge, skills and training they will require going forward.

Platform Architecture, Design and Implementation Services

Under the direction of ITD, the Proponent will be responsible for architecting, designing, and integrating additional capabilities into the overall technology platform environment. This includes working with ITD for selecting components either through utilizing capabilities available through existing Enterprise Services products and vendors or through an acquisition process for adding new products and vendors.

The evolution will be based on Ministry demand and on a cost recovery approach. That is, the services will grow as fast as the Ministries have the need and resources to take on additional capabilities and functionality.

New Capability Implementation Services

Working with ITD, the Successful Proponent will be expected to facilitate the acquisition, technical implementation and services integration of new capabilities approved through GOS funding processes.

ITD is interested in approaches the Proponent would recommend for introducing new functionality and related services to the environment (such as, but not limited to proof of concepts or pilots).

The Proponent will be responsible to ensure the required on-going sustainment and support services for these new capabilities are established through respective partnerships which may include any combination of their own resources, vendors in the IT sector, ITD and/or Ministry resources.

C. MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS

The mandatory requirements are listed in Appendix D – Mandatory Requirements and Submission Form.

D. RATED CRITERIA

The following is an overview of the categories and weighting for the rated criteria of the RFP. Proponents who do not meet a minimum threshold score may not proceed to the next stage of the evaluation process.

Rated Criteria Category	Weighting (Points)	Percentage
Scoring based on written proposal (Stage II – Written Evaluation 1):		
D.1 Proponent Profile	2.5	2.5%
D.2 Proponent Experience and Qualifications	10	10%
D.3 Proposed Approach	7.5	7.5%
D.4 Risk Management Plan	5	5%
D.5 Proposed Team and Resources	5	5%
D.6 Value Add-ons and Innovation	5	5%
D.7 Local / Industry Knowledge	15	15%
Subtotal Written Evaluation 1	50	50%
Scoring based on written proposal (Stage IV – Written Evaluation 2):		
D.8 Services Delivery and Transition Plan	15	15%
D.9 IT Requirements and Specifications	5	5%
D.10 Information Security Requirements	5	5%
Subtotal Written Evaluation 2	25	25%
D.11 Pricing	25	25%
Total Points	100	100%

Submissions that receive less than 65% of the written evaluation points may be rejected. The Evaluation Team will determine how many Submissions, if any, will be short-listed.

Any Submission ranked at the lower-end of the scale in any of the stages may be rejected.

D.1 Proponent Profile

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

A brief introduction and overview of your company, its services and its partnerships; particularly as they are related to this RFP. GOS is seeking the following information:

D.1.1 Existing Proponent services and practices that align with providing the Deliverables outlined in Appendix A.

D.1.2 Location of head office and any sub-offices.

D.1.3 Details of any and all subcontracting or partnership arrangements proposed by the Proponent specifically relating to the provision of Services as described herein. Outline the nature of the proposed involvement and the nature of the relationship.

NOTE: The information asked for above should be provided for all Proponents partners and sub-contractors included in Submission.

D.2 Proponent Experience and Qualifications

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

Similar successful engagements of similar size and scope as described in this RFP that demonstrate the Proponent's experience and qualifications to provide the services outlined in sub-sections D.2.1 to D.2.4 below.

NOTE: Projects that represent a similar approach/structure as that which is being proposed are desired. If, for example, you are proposing to engage a specific legist unit or supplier partner in your proposed approach, it is preferred that project examples provided in response to this section include similarly structured engagements.

For each project, provide, at a minimum:

1. An overview of the engagement including client details such as name, contact information, and client industry;
2. A description of the roles and responsibilities your firm, and any partner organizations, had in the engagement;
3. An overview of how the engagement aligns with the scope and scale of the requirements outlined in this RFP;
4. Project timelines and key milestones including transition and implementation;
5. A list of the deliverables and acceptance criteria;
6. A description of the challenges experienced, and key learnings gained by your firm as a result of involvement in the engagement.

Top-ranked Proponents may be asked to provide or confirm client references (including contact name and e-mail address) for each project.

D.2.1 Describe in detail, engagements that align with establishing a governance model articulated in **Appendix A Section B.1 Governance**.

D.2.2 Describe in detail, engagements that align with the support of existing data management and analytic platform services articulated in **Appendix A Section B.2 Managed Services for Current Information Management Technology Platforms**. This includes direct support of the IBM Infosphere, and IBM Cognos software platform and supplemental support for the Microsoft Power BI and ESRI ArcGIS platforms when required.

D.2.3 Describe in detail, engagements that align with establishing a plan for additional data management and analytic platform services articulated in **Appendix A Section B.3 Information Management Technology Platform Planning**.

D.2.4 Describe in detail, engagements that align with implementing and supporting additional data management and analytic platform services articulated in **Appendix A Section B.4 Service Delivery Transformation and Additional Capability Implementation**.

D.3 Proposed Approach

Each Proponent should provide a description of your approach to meet the requirements and considerations specified in Appendix A.

D.3.1 Describe, in detail, your proposed approach and how it will assist GOS in realizing the services and deliverables specified in **Appendix A Section B.1 Governance**. In your Submission, list and describe any other benefits GOS may realize from implementation of your proposed approach.

D.3.2 Describe, in detail, your proposed approach and how it will assist GOS in realizing the services and deliverables specified in **Appendix A Section B.2 Managed Services for Current Information Management Technology Platforms**. In your Submission, list and describe any other benefits GOS may realize from implementation of your proposed approach.

D.3.2.3 Describe, in detail, your proposed approach and how it will assist GOS in realizing the services and deliverables specified in **Appendix A Section B.3 Information Management Technology Platform Planning**. In your Submission, list and describe any other benefits GOS may realize from implementation of your proposed approach.

D.3.2.4 Describe, in detail, your proposed approach and how it will assist GOS in realizing the services and deliverables specified in **Appendix A Section B.4 Service Delivery Transformation and Additional Capability Implementation**. In your Submission, list and describe any other benefits GOS may realize from implementation of your proposed approach.

D.3.3 Describe, in detail, how your proposed approach will deal with each of the Material Disclosures specified in **Section B; Material Disclosures**.

D.3.4 Describe, in detail, how your proposed approach will meet each of the Mandatory Requirements in **Section C; Mandatory Requirements**.

D.4 Risk Management Plan

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

Describe your approach to risk management. The risk management plan should outline potential risks, the risk owners and plans for mitigating the risks and capture potential risks that fall into the following categories:

D.4.1 People Risks: Risks related to the capability / capacity of resources as well as risks associated with management control changes.

D.4.2 Project Risks: Risks related to the program management, governance and handover / establishment of obligations.

D.4.3 Technology Risks: Risks that threaten the performance of the seamless Transition-In including any risks related to technology operations.

D.4.4 Enterprise Risks: Risks related to all parties involved in the project, delivery of goods or services (Internal, External, Community organizations etc.).

D.5 Proposed Team Structure and Resources

D.5.1 Team Information

- Describe the proposed team structure and roles for:
 - Service Governance
 - Support of existing services
 - Platform architecture planning
 - Implementation and support of additional platform capabilities
- Explain how this composition and structure will provide effective service delivery and achievement of performance standards.
- Describe how the team composition and structure would align with the proposed approach.

D.5.2 Resource Pool Depth – Describe the size of the respective service teams available to provide services and/or deliverables articulated in this RFP. Indicate your approach to addressing new requests or replacement of a team resource(s) (if required) once the resource is working under a contract with the GOS. Describe your approach to the assignment of its resources, including how the Proponent proposes to deal with vacation, illness, resignations, training and other absences without impact to service delivery.

D.6 Value Add-ons and Innovation

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

D.6.1 Details should include any creative alternatives, opportunities, additional benefits or innovations that may be beneficial to the project which, if considered by GOS, would enhance the services provided.

D.6.2 GOS wants to be recognized for taking steps to realize the importance of protecting our environment. Each Proponent should indicate if they participate or are involved in “Green” environmental and/or sustainable initiatives. If so, provide descriptions of the initiatives.

D.7 Local / Industry Knowledge

The GOS and its Ministry stakeholders are interested in understanding the service provider’s experience with the Government of Saskatchewan, or comparable entity, as it relates to the technical and business landscape.

D.7.1 Outline your organization’s experience and knowledge of Government of Saskatchewan’s business and operations (or comparable entity). Indicate the relative timelines in which this experience and knowledge has been acquired.

D.7.2 Outline your organization’s experience and knowledge of public service organizations (Federal, Provincial, Municipal, Boards, Agencies or non-Profit). Indicate the relative timelines in which this experience and knowledge has been acquired.

D.7.3 Outline your organization’s experience and knowledge of applicable Acts, Regulations, and Policies (Federal or Provincial) relating to data management and protection. Indicate how recent this knowledge has been acquired.

Important Notice to Proponents:

- **As outlined in PART 2 - EVALUATION AND NEGOTIATION 2.1 Stages of Evaluation and Negotiation, Proponents will be evaluated on sections D.1 to D.7 above. Only those Proponents shortlisted through the evaluation process will be required to respond to the remaining sections below:**

D.8 Services Delivery and Transition Plan

Provide a detailed response to the items listed in Appendix I Rated Criteria. Note: there are tabs in the spreadsheet that have categorized the items into five sections including “Current Services”, “Service Levels and Reporting”, “Service Transition”, “Platform Services Planning” and “Platform Transformation”.

D.9 Information Technology (IT) Requirements

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

D.9.1 If proposed, provide a detailed description of any IT related software or solutions for any aspect of the delivery of your proposed solution and services.

D.9.1 Describe, in detail, the integration of any new solutions (if proposed) as specified in this RFP with the existing Enterprise Reporting Services. Please note any alignment with GoS standards found in Appendix F – ITD Environment and Appendix H – Infrastructure & Architecture and / or industry standards where applicable.

D.10 Information Security Requirements

Each Proponent should provide the following in its Submission:

D.10.1 General Information Security Requirements

Describe, in detail, the extent to which the proposed Solution and/or Service aligns with each of the requirements listed in Section 1.1, General Information Security Requirements, of Appendix G, Information Security.

D.10.2 Data Classification Security Requirements

Describe, in detail, the extent to which the proposed Solution and/or Service aligns with each of the requirements listed in Section 1.2, Data Classification Security Requirements, of Appendix G, Information Security.

In circumstances where one or more data classification security requirements are not met or based on the respondent’s expertise, are not feasible or applicable, respondents should articulate their position and describe how the potential risk from not meeting the requirement(s) will be mitigated by the service provider to the satisfaction of the client ministry. It is also possible that the service provider will have requirements which are more rigorous than those used by GOS as a baseline.

D.10.3 Overarching Information Security Policy / Security Objectives and Controls Statement

The GOS desires engagement with service providers who can demonstrate a strong information security posture and maturity. Review Appendix G, Information Security, Section 2, Overarching Information Security Policy, and state your understanding of the information presented in the Overarching Information Security Policy.

Describe, in detail, the extent to which the proposed Solution and/or Service aligns with each of the requirements listed in Section 2.4 Minimum Security Requirements and 2.5 Security Program Capability Objectives of the Overarching Information Security Policies Requirements, of Appendix G, Information Security. Also, describe in detail the security controls for the proposed solution in which will be implemented that will align with the Data Classification Security Requirements and the domains in section 2.5 Security Program Requirements objectives as a minimum baseline.

In circumstances where one or more of the requirements are not met or based on the respondent's expertise, are not feasible or applicable, respondents should articulate their position and describe how the potential risk from not meeting the requirement(s) will be mitigated by the Service Provider to the satisfaction of the client ministry.

D.10.4 Information Security Policies

Review Appendix G, Information Security, Section 3, Information Security Policies, and state your understanding. In your response, articulate the extent to which the service provider's established Information Security Policies align with those established by GOS.

Service providers should append and reference a copy of their established Information Security Policies or, at a minimum, provide an outline of their policies and confirm the industry standard framework(s) to which they align.

D.11 Pricing

Pricing will be kept separate from the written proposal evaluation. It will only be accessed after written proposals are completed.

Pricing will be scored based on a relative pricing formula using the rates set out in the Pricing Form. Each Proponent will receive a percentage of the total possible points, which will be calculated in accordance with the following formula:

$$\text{lowest price} \div \text{proponent's price} \times \text{weighting} = \text{proponent's pricing points}$$

E. OTHER RATED CRITERIA

Optional Rated Criteria Category (See PART 2)	Weighting (Points)
E.1 Interviews/Presentations/Demonstrations	60
E.2 Reference Checks	40
Total Points	100
E.3 BAFO	To Be Determined

Details for Other Rated Criteria will be provided to top-ranked Proponents as outlined in PART 2 of this RFP.

F. SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

Submissions should also include all the information requested, and be presented, in the order described below:

F.1 Table of Contents

A listing of the Submission contents with reference to the appropriate page number. Page numbering and tabs are beneficial.

F.2 Letter of Introduction

One page of introduction which should be dated and signed by an official authorized to negotiate, make commitments and provide clarifications with respect to the Submission on behalf of the Proponent.

F.3 Executive Summary

Provide a summary of the key features of your Submission.

F.4 Forms

Mandatory Requirements and Submission Form

Each Submission must respond to the Mandatory Requirements and include a Submission Form (Appendix D), or a document containing the information requested by the Submission Form, completed and signed by an authorized representative of the Proponent.

Pricing Form

Each Submission should include a Pricing Form (Appendix B), or a document containing the information requested by the Pricing Form, completed in accordance with the instructions contained in the form.

F.5 Rated Criteria

Each Submission should include a response to each of the rated criteria (Section D of this Appendix) completed according to the instructions contained in the form.

APPENDIX B – PRICING FORM

To be provided to shortlisted Proponents.

APPENDIX C - FORM OF AGREEMENT

Proponents are asked to review Appendix C – Form of Agreement and state any requested deviations to this appendix as part of their submission. Suppliers that hold an active Ministry of SaskBuilds and Procurement (formerly Central Services) Master Terms and Conditions are not required to review this Appendix.

APPENDIX D - MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS & SUBMISSION FORM

1. Mandatory Requirements

Proponents should complete the following table:

The Proponent agrees to the following:	Yes	No	Pg.#
Mandatory #1 - Service providers are required to review Appendix C, Form of Agreement and agree to one of the following: 1.Yes, you accept the terms and conditions as outlined in the Appendix, or 2.You provide a markup with requested changes to the Appendix, or 3.You advise that you have a current SaskBuilds and Procurement (formerly Central Services) Master Terms and Conditions and agree that it will be used for any engagement resulting from this competition.			
Mandatory #2 - The Proponent confirms it has established Information Security Policies, Standards, and Specifications which align with ISO 27002:2013 or a similar/equivalent, industry-recognized code of practice for information security controls. These are outlined in Appendix G - Information Security			
Mandatory #3 - The prospective solution shall be in compliance with the relevant policies and standards of the Government of Saskatchewan (e.g., Information Security standard for Class A data, Privacy and Records Retention).			
Mandatory #4 - The Proponent confirms that its proposed Services and Solution delivery approaches will ensure that all data at rest, including data backups, remain in Canada.			

2. Proponent Information

Please fill out the following form, naming one person to be the Proponent's contact for the RFP process and for any clarifications or communication that might be necessary.	
Full Legal Name of Proponent:	
Saskatchewan Business Registration Number: (or equivalent)	
Any Other Relevant Name under which Proponent Carries on Business:	
Street Address:	
City, Province/State:	

Please fill out the following form, naming one person to be the Proponent's contact for the RFP process and for any clarifications or communication that might be necessary.	
Postal Code:	
Phone Number:	
Company Website (if any):	
Proponent Contact Name and Title:	
Proponent Contact Phone:	
Proponent Contact Email:	
For reporting purposes only, businesses that meet all the below criteria are asked to check the following box to declare as a Saskatchewan Business. ☐ - Have a place of business in Saskatchewan. This place of business refers to an establishment where regular business activities are conducted on a permanent basis, is clearly identified by name and is accessible during normal business hours; - Employ Saskatchewan residents or sole proprietorship owned by a Saskatchewan resident; and - Be a registered business in Saskatchewan with an Information Services Corporation profile or equivalent.	
Physical Address of Saskatchewan Office:	☐ Same as Above ☐ Not Applicable ☐ Address (Provide Street, City, and Postal Code):

The Proponent acknowledges the RFP process will be governed by the terms and conditions of the RFP and that, among other things, such terms and conditions confirm that this procurement process does not constitute a formal, legally binding bidding process (and for greater certainty, does not give rise to a Contract A bidding process contract), and that no legal relationship or obligation regarding the procurement of any good or service will be created between GOS and the Proponent unless and until GOS and the Proponent execute a written Agreement for the Deliverables.

Signature of Proponent Representative

Title of Proponent Representative

Name of Proponent Representative

Date

APPENDIX E - DEFINITIONS

Throughout this RFP, the following definitions apply:

“Agreement” means the written contract between the top-ranked Proponent and His Majesty to provide the services contemplated by this RFP.

“Client” (referring to ministry) means His Majesty the King in Right of the Province of Saskatchewan, as represented by the Ministry of SaskBuilds and Procurement.

“Desirable” “Rated” “Should” means requirements that may have a degree of importance to be objectives of this RFP and may be rated.

“Deliverables” means the functions, duties, tasks and responsibilities to be provided by the Proponent as described in this RFP.

“Delivered Duty Paid” refers to a transaction where the seller pays for the total costs associated with transporting goods and is fully responsible for the goods until they are received and transferred to the buyer. This includes paying for costs, export and import duties, insurance and any other expenses incurred during shipping of the goods. The risks and charges are with the seller of the goods until delivery is made in the buyer’s country at an agreed-upon location.

“Entity” refers to the Government of Saskatchewan, the province or ministries are used for administrative purposes and mean His Majesty the King in Right of the Province of Saskatchewan, as represented by the Minister of SaskBuilds and Procurement.

“Evaluation Team” means the individuals who will evaluate the Submissions on behalf of the Government of Saskatchewan.

“GST” means Goods and Services Tax (currently at 5%).

“Mandatory” means requirements that are imperative and must be met in order for the proposal to receive consideration.

“RFP” means Request for Proposal.

“PST” means Saskatchewan Provincial Sales Tax (currently 6%).

“Proponent” “Service Provider” means an individual or a company that provides, or intends to provide, a Submission in response to this RFP.

“Saskatchewan Time” means Local Saskatchewan Time as verified by the time clock located at 1855 Victoria Avenue, Regina, SK.

“Submission” means the bid, proposal, or document provided by a Proponent in response to the RFP.

“Successful Supplier” means the organization responding to this RFP who is determined to be successful in this competition and has signed an Agreement.

APPENDIX F - ITD ENVIRONMENT

The above mentioned Appendix may be found as an attached document to this Competition. It lists ITD's technology information environment and should be taken in consideration while building your submission.

APPENDIX G - INFORMATION SECURITY

The above mentioned Appendix may be found as an attached document to this Competition. It lists ITD's information security requirements and should be taken in consideration while building your submission.

APPENDIX H - INFRASTRUCTURE AND ARCHITECTURE

The above mentioned Appendix may be found as an attached document to this Competition. It describes ITD's considerations in regards to the Solution's Infrastructure and Architecture requirements and should be taken in consideration while building your submission.

APPENDIX I - RATED CRITERIA

Rated Criteria is an attached spreadsheet describing the evaluation criteria for the desired elements of the solution/service.

This section is only to be completed by Proponents who have been shortlisted to the Due Diligence phase (see 2.4 Stage III –Due Diligence).

Your submission must contain the completed document in order to be evaluated.

APPENDIX J – NOT REQUIRED

APPENDIX K – NOT REQUIRED

APPENDIX L – NOT REQUIRED

APPENDIX M – CONFIDENTIALITY AGREEMENT